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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1982-1983

Coverage Date: 1982-1983

Place Coverage

Kade area, Central Kalahari Game Reserve, Botswana

Section Title(S)

(3) Generation and Proximity/Contact • (3) Individual Variation in Close Neighbors

From these results it could not be proven that avoidance toward the adjacent generation, one of the main principles of so-called joking-avoidance relationship, is operating at the level of bodily proximity and contact. In other words, proximity and contact among the San occur, as a whole, almost irrespectively of generation. However, as was demonstrated in the above section, physical contact was strongly avoided between in-laws belonging to adjacent generations. In the following section the examination of individual variation in the kinds of close neighbors will also demonstrate several cases in which a person evidently avoids being in contact with his or her primary affines of adjacent generations. Thus generation difference seems to affect the occurrence of physical contact only between very close affines, but this fact conversely suggests that the generation itself exerts little effect on interpersonal spacing in general. Because the avoidance of parents-in-law is so complex a social phenomenon deeply rooted in the nature of conjugal relationships, it cannot be reduced to only a generational factor.

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(3) Individual Variation in Close Neighbors

In this section the kinds of close neighbors will be examined for those individuals of which the sample sizes are relatively large, elucidating what variation is found in close neighbors among these individuals.

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The subjects of this analysis are an old male (KM-4), 4 adult males (NK-5, CH-6, SH-8, KN-9), an old female (go-3), and 4 adult females (ga-11, no-14, da-12,

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and ha-13). For each individual, the 1st to 5th most frequent neighbors, i.e., those who had appeared more frequently than others within the vicinity (2 m) of each focal individual during all focal sampling sessions, are represented in Figure 13.

First, the variation among males is examined (Fig. 13(a)). The common feature of these 5 males is that all of them have one or more adolescent male as a frequent neighbor. Especially, 2 particular males, KR-12 and HO-13, frequently appeared as close neighbors. Both are non-consanguines to these 5 focal males. Especially the relations between CH-6 and these 2 adolescent males very properly fall under the concept of the 'joking relation'. The following 2 cases are worth describing in detail.

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Proxemics

Case 2. 20th November. 15:30 In the shade of a tree in Camp VI, CH-6, ko-9, go-3, and no-14 are sleeping soundly. KR-12 comes, and binds CH-6's left ankle with a skin rope hanging from the branch of the tree. CH-6's knee is forcibly bent in an upright position. CH-6 opens his eyes slightly, but does not condemn this treatment. CH-6's second son (DJ: estimated to be 10–11 years old) seeing this incident smiles with embarrassment. As soon as KR-12 has left, DJ tries to untie the rope from the branch, but he stops this attempt as the rope pulls CH-6's leg. At last DJ stoops over CH-6's feet and loosens his ankle from the rope.

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Proxemics

Case 3. 19th December. 15:08 In the shade of a tree in Camp VI, 9 men and 8 juveniles are resting closely together. CH-6 is lying on his right side. HO-13 is lying on his back and sleeping soundly, with his flank in contact with CH-6's. CH-6 begins to fumble around the belly of HO-13, and takes out a tobacco bag which has been put between his shirt and belly. CH-6 hands it over to KR-12 sitting beside, and draws HO-13's shirt down to 32

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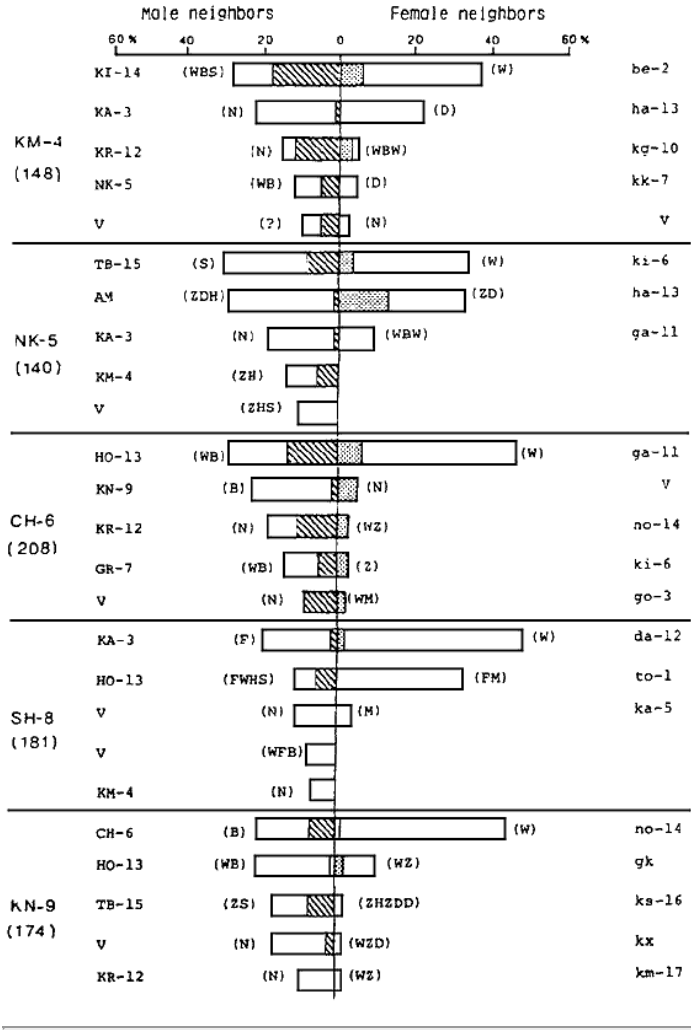
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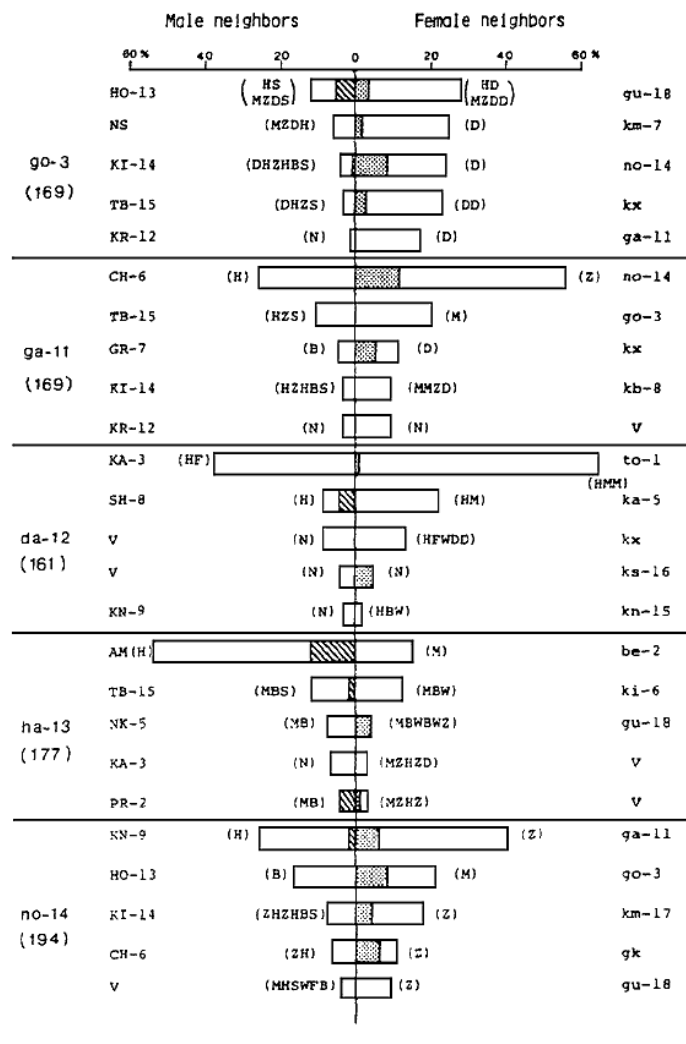
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Proxemics

Fig. 13. The 1st to 5th most frequent neighbors for (a) 5 focal males and (b) 5 focal females. White bars and shadowed bars represent the percentages of the observation units for which each neighbor was in proximity (within 2 m), and in physical contact with focal individuals, respectively. Names of focal individuals are given on the left side. Figures in parentheses indicate the numbers of observation units of focal individual sampling. Capital letters in the parentheses indicate the kinship position of each neighbor from the viewpoint of the focal individual.

F: father, M: mother, B: brother, Z: sister, S: son, D: daughter, H: husband, W: wife, N: non-kinsmen, V: visitors.





34 cover his navel. Then CH-6 pats gently HO-13's belly. Still sleeping, HO-13 is unaware of this incident. KN-9 (CH-6's younger brother), who has been sitting in this gathering, fills his pipe.

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